
TECH DEBT
AI
PRODUCTIVITY
AGI SOON™
JUST 10x WITH AI
Be more specific...
Add more context.
Try again.
That's not quite right...
One more iteration...
PROMPT
LEGACY CODE
Spaghetti
No Docs
Mystery Logic
Works Somehow
Don't Touch
Critical System
IDEAS IN
HALLUCINATIONS OUT
STAGING
PRODUCTION
Analyze this
Refactor this
Add tests
Make it scalable
Now in Rust
Now in Go
Explain further...
Optimize this
One more change...
Now do it again...
CODE REVIEWS
Needs more tests
Consider edge cases
This is not scalable
Can we make it simpler?
Add comments
Change naming
Not a fan
Please refactor
Let's some suggestions...
GPU
GPU
GPU
MORE COMPUTE PLZ
FASTER
MORE FEATURES
HIGHER OUTPUT
DO MORE WITH AI
LAYOFFS
KPIs
THE COMPANY
Bigger Margins
Fewer People
More AI
Same Deadlines
Growth Always
YOU WERE REPLACED BY
AI
Automation
Cost Savings
Restructuring
Synergies
A Brighter Future
NEXT SPRINT
DEPLOYMENT
404 DEPLOYMENT FAILED
Error: Something went wrong.
"Works on my machine"
SPRINT
SPRINT
SPRINT
FOREVER
JIRA
To Do 999+
In Progress 999+
In Review 999+
Blocked 999+
Done 0
BURNOUT
MORE IDEAS?
Add a feature
Improve UX
Integrate AI
Scale globally
Run A/B tests
Do it faster

On Agent Harnesses and Finding New Abstractions

Benjamin Strasser & Jacob Palecek

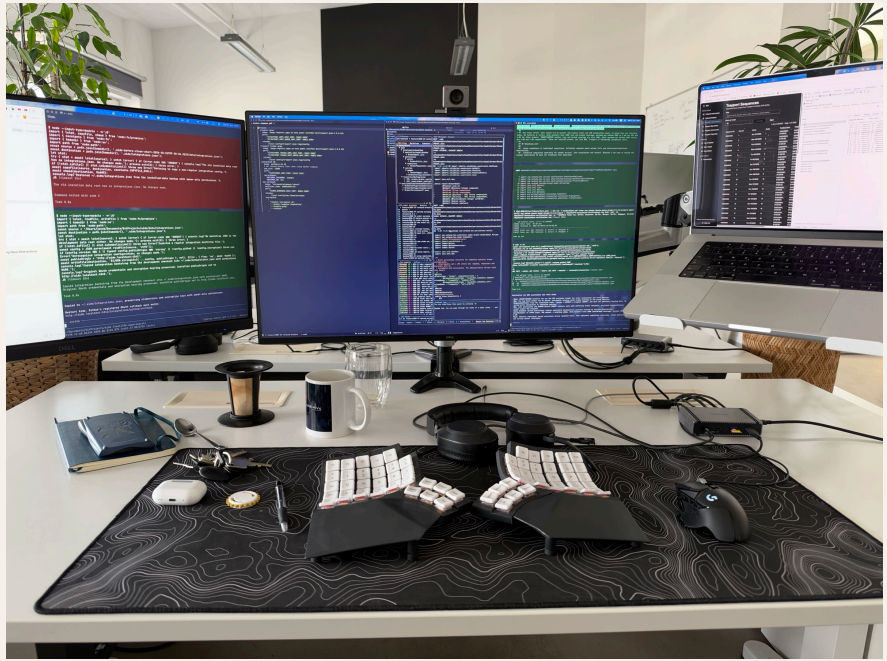
Lead Software Engineers & Co-founders

Ahead of Time Software (aots) · Vienna

How has our work changed?

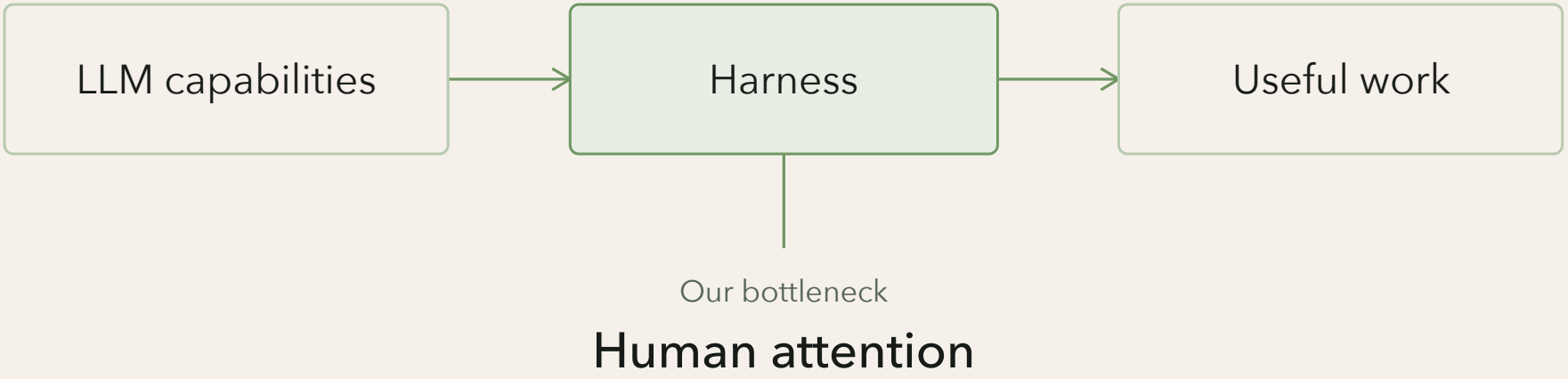
We're doing more than ever—and we're more exhausted than ever.

- More tools
- More sessions
- More parallel work



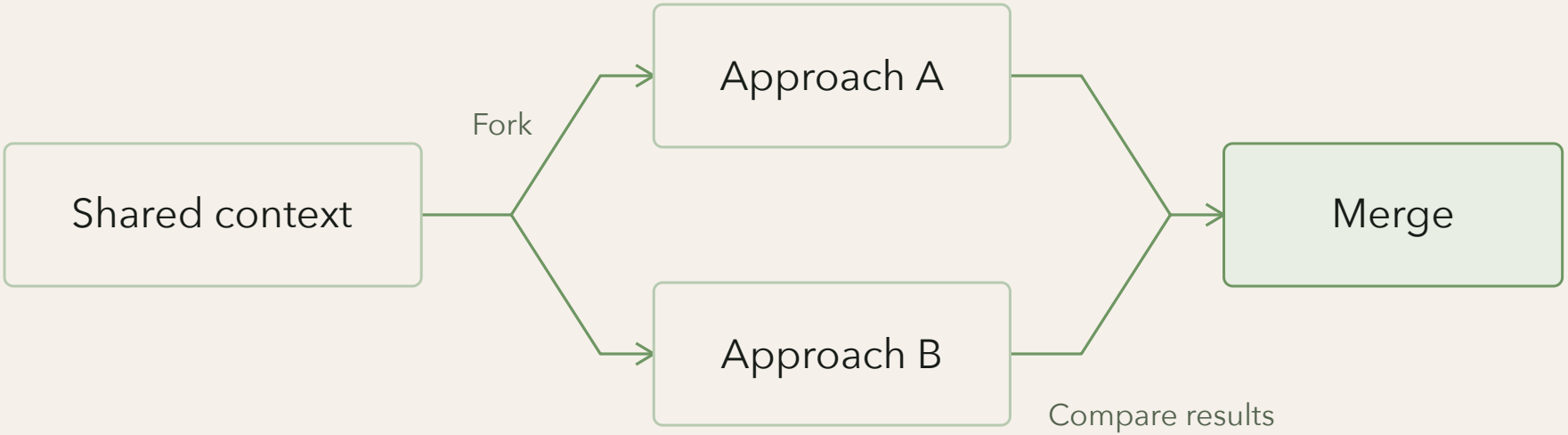
What makes a good agent harness?

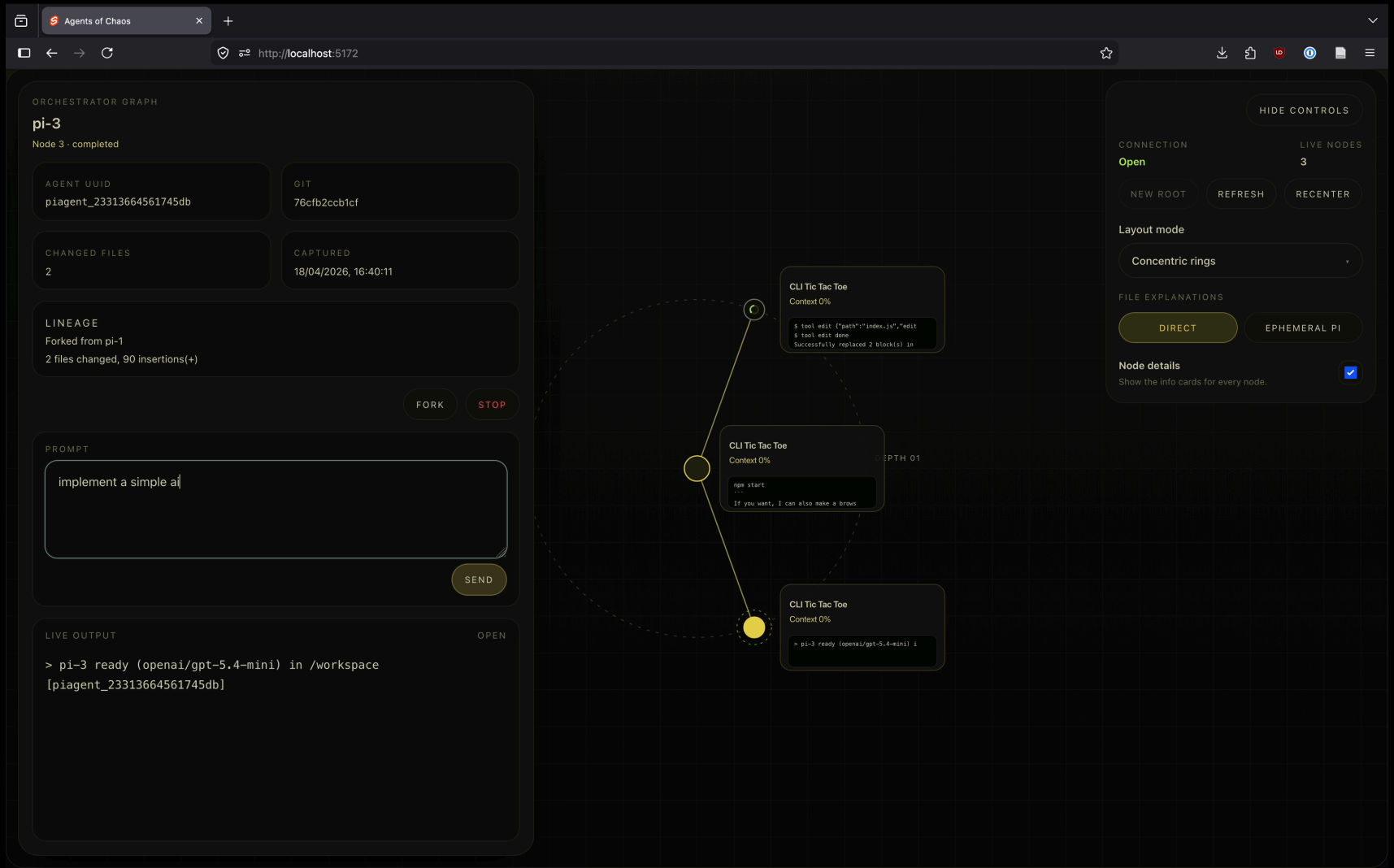
A good harness lets us get the most value from an LLM's intelligence and capabilities.



How it started: Agents of Chaos

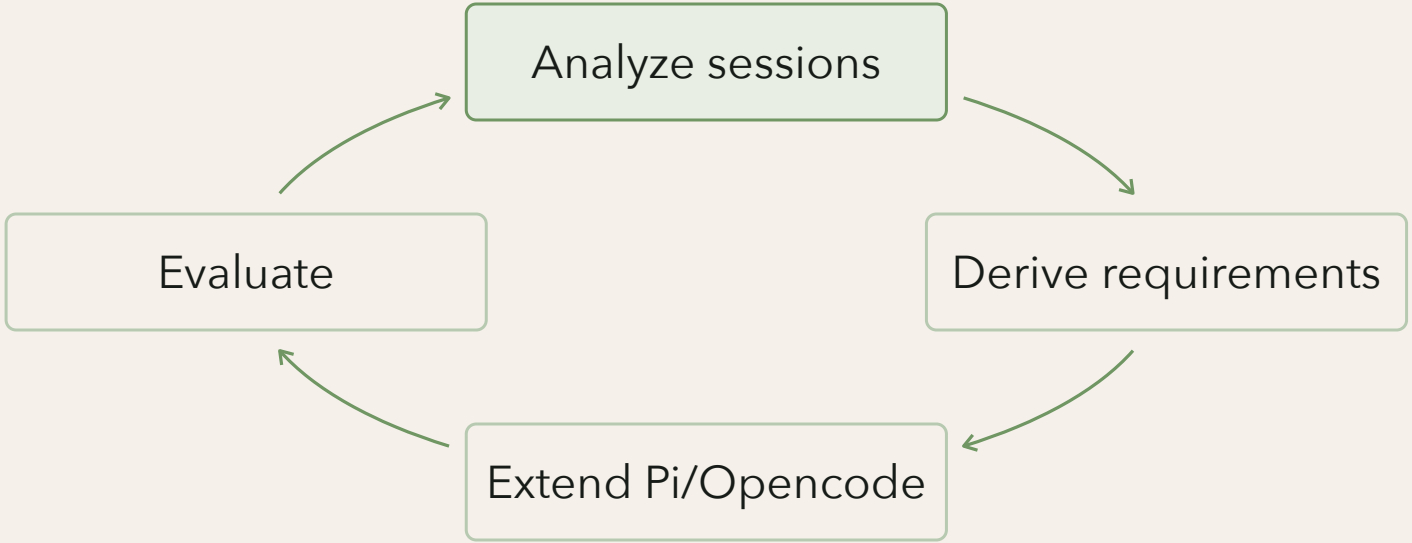
Second prize at the OpenAI Codex hackathon in Vienna.
(with Jürgen Brandl and Simeon Macke)




Agents of Chaos
http://localhost:5172
ORCHESTRATOR GRAPH
pi-3
Node 3 · completed
AGENT UUID
piagent_23313664561745db
GIT
76cfb2ccb1cf
CHANGED FILES
2
CAPTURED
18/04/2026, 16:40:11
LINEAGE
Forked from pi-1
2 files changed, 90 insertions(+)
FORK
STOP
PROMPT
implement a simple ai
SEND
LIVE OUTPUT
OPEN
> pi-3 ready (openai/gpt-5.4-mini) in /workspace
[piagent_23313664561745db]
CLI Tic Tac Toe
Context 0%
$ tool edit {"path":"index.js","edit
$ tool edit done
Successfully replaced 2 block(s) in
CLI Tic Tac Toe
Context 0%
npm start
If you want, I can also make a brows
CLI Tic Tac Toe
Context 0%
> pi-3 ready (openai/gpt-5.4-mini) i
HIDE CONTROLS
CONNECTION
Open
LIVE NODES
3
NEW ROOT
REFRESH
RECENTER
Layout mode
Concentric rings
FILE EXPLANATIONS
DIRECT
EPHEMERAL PI
Node details
Show the info cards for every node.

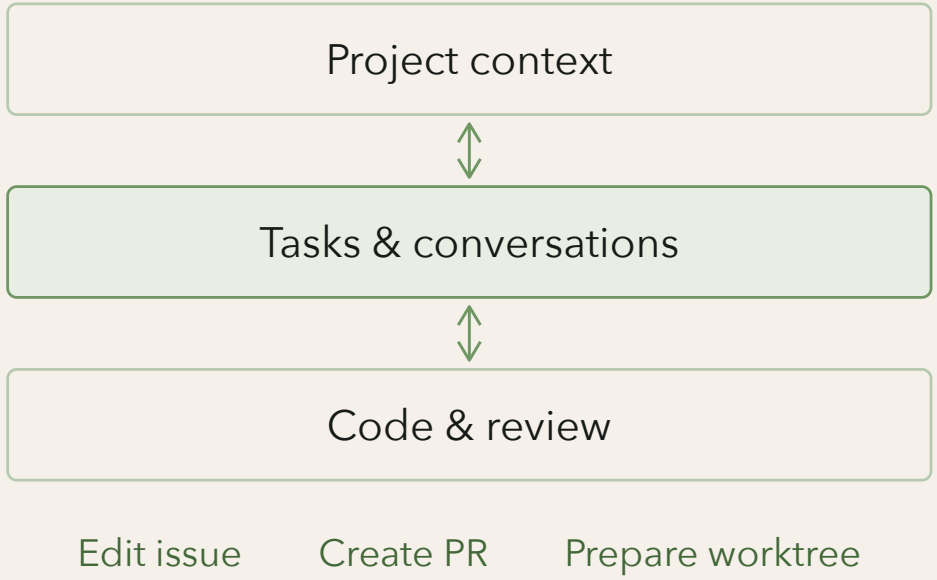
What then?

What do we actually need?



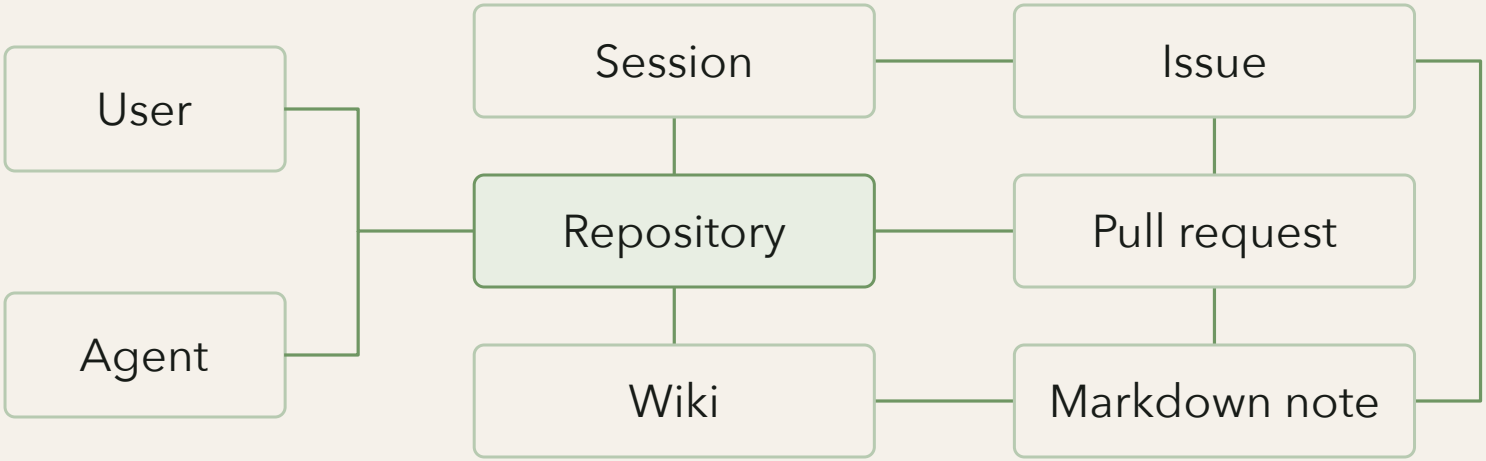
Designing around how we work

Custom is cheap now.



Our interpretation: Aide

Everything is a resource.



Demo

Lessons and caveats

- Reliability takes engineering.
- Models keep changing.
- Switching costs matter.
- Extensions can be enough.
- Know your bottleneck.

Directions we see

Your mileage may vary.

Integration

Universal Interaction Surface

Real-time durable collaboration

Universal multiplayer

Security & execution

Access and environments

Flexible composition

Changing project needs

Sign up to be an alpha tester

or don’t, who knows if this will be released…



https://forms.cloud.microsoft/e/DdCfcujHCv